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Scepter

1.10.3 Scepter

References:

Hebrew חקק (mchoqeq) GEN 49:10, NUM 21:18, PSA 60:9, PSA 108:9

Hebrew מַטֶּה (mateh) PSA 110:2, JER 48:17

Hebrew מַקֵּל (maqel) JER 48:17

Hebrew שֵׁבֶט (shevet) GEN 49:10, NUM 24:17, JDG 5:14, PSA 45:7, PSA 45:7, PSA 125:3, ISA 14:5, EZK 19:11, EZK 19:14, AMO 1:5, AMO 1:8, ZEC 10:11

Hebrew שַׁרְבִיט (sharvit) EST 4:11, EST 5:2, EST 5:2, EST 8:4

Greek ῥάβδος (rhabdos) HEB 1:8, HEB 1:8, ESG 5:2

Greek σκῆπτρον (skēptron) ESG 4:17, WIS 6:21, WIS 7:8, WIS 10:14, SIR 35:21, LJE 1:12

Description and usage:

Head of a scepter (Gary Todd, Israel Museum, CC0, via Wikimedia Commons)The scepter was a decorated rod, often made at least partially of a precious metal, symbolizing the authority of the ruler. The ruler held the scepter when he was engaged in certain aspects of his office. See also 1.2.4 Rod, club, shepherd's staff<REALIA:1.2.4>.

Translation:

In languages where a chief's authority is symbolized by an object associated with him (such as a cane, stool, or scepter), such symbols of authority can often be used in translation; for example, PSA 45:7 may be rendered "Your ceremonial staff shows that you rule your people fairly."

The Hebrew words *mateh* and *maqel* are parallel to each other in JER 48:17. It is not always necessary to reproduce the parallelism with two similar words; for example, for the last half of this verse RSV has "How the mighty scepter is broken, the glorious staff," but GNT says "Its powerful rule has been broken; its glory and might are no more." This passage is metaphorical, so the focus here is not on the scepter as a physical object but on authority.